

Records Retention & Legal Hold Policy

Policy Category: Legal Governance & Information Lifecycle

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Owner	General Counsel	Approved By	Executive Legal Committee
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1. PURPOSE

Governs the lifecycle, secure archiving, and mandatory suspension of deletion protocols for corporate records and logs.

2. SCOPE

Applies to all electronic and physical records generated or maintained by Acme Corporation personnel.

3. DEFINITIONS

- **Legal Hold:** A formal directive suspending normal document destruction and record deletion schedules due to anticipated or pending litigation.
- **Investigation Record:** Documentation, evidence packages, and interview logs compiled during compliance or security investigations.

4. POLICY / REQUIREMENTS

REC-RET-001: Security incident records and investigation logs MUST be retained for 5 years. (Creates an intentional overlap/distinction with the 180-day general security log rule in POL-SEC-01).
REC-HLD-001: Upon issuance of a Legal Hold, all regular deletion and automated purging schedules for impacted records MUST be immediately suspended.
REC-RET-002: Corporate contracts and third-party vendor agreements must be retained for 7 years post-termination.

5. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

General Counsel issues legal holds; Department heads ensure compliance with retention schedules within their operational units.

6. CONTROL REQUIREMENTS

Automated storage systems must respect hold flags and block lifecycle deletion routines while a hold is active.

7. EXCEPTIONS

Early destruction of records requires written sign-off from the General Counsel.

8. MONITORING & COMPLIANCE

Annual audits of retention schedules and storage bin configurations.

9. RECORDS / EVIDENCE

Legal hold distribution lists and acknowledgment logs must be stored permanently within the legal repository.

10. INCIDENT / ESCALATION REQUIREMENTS

Any breach of a legal hold directive must be escalated to the General Counsel within 2 hours.

11. REVIEW & GOVERNANCE

Annual review by the Executive Legal Committee.

12. REFERENCES

- Federal Rules of Civil Procedure (FRCP)

13. CROSS-REFERENCES

- POL-SEC-01 (Information Security Policy)
- STD-PRV-02 (Data Protection & Privacy Standard)
- PROC-IR-01 (Security Incident Response Procedure)

APPENDIX A — CONTROL MATRIX

Control ID	Domain	Requirement Summary
REC-RET-001	Records Management	Security Incident Record Retention (5 Years)
REC-HLD-001	Legal Hold	Suspension of Deletion Schedules